

NORTHWIND TRADERS

Global Sales & Operations Dashboard Report

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Tool Used: Microsoft Excel

1. Executive Summary

This report presents a business intelligence dashboard built for Northwind Traders, a global gourmet food supplier. The dashboard analyses sales performance, product category intelligence, and regional and people performance across 2013, 2014 and 2015. The dataset covers 999 orders, 91 customers, and total revenue of \$1,265,793 across multiple countries and product categories. The dashboard was built using Microsoft Excel with PivotTables, charts, and interactive slicers to enable dynamic filtering by year, category and country.

2. Dashboard Structure

The dashboard is organized into three pages:

Page 1 - Sales & Revenue Overview: This page shows the total revenue of \$1,265,793, total orders of 999 and total customers of 91. It includes a Revenue by Year chart showing that 2014 was the strongest year with \$617,085 in revenue, and an Orders by Month chart showing seasonal patterns in order volume.

Three interactive slicers for Year, Category and Country allow users to filter all data dynamically.

Page 2 - Product & Category Intelligence: This page shows Revenue by Category and Top 10 Products by Revenue. Beverages is the top performing category with \$267,868 in revenue, followed by Dairy Products with \$234,165. Côte de Blaye is the single highest revenue product with \$141,396.

Page 3 - Regional, Operational & People Performance: This page shows Revenue by Country and Top Employees by Sales. USA leads with \$245,584 in revenue followed by Germany with \$230,284. Margaret Peacock is the top performing employee with \$232,890 in total sales.

3. Key Findings

Finding 1 - Revenue Growth: Revenue grew significantly from \$208,084 in 2013 to \$617,085 in 2014, representing a 197% increase. However revenue dropped to \$440,624 in 2015, suggesting a slowdown that management should investigate.

Finding 2 - Top Category: Beverages consistently drives the highest revenue across all years at \$267,868, making it the most critical product category for Northwind Traders. Grains & Cereals is the lowest performing category at \$95,647 and may need promotional attention.

Finding 3 - Regional Performance: USA and Germany are the two strongest markets contributing \$245,584 and \$230,284 respectively. Together they account for approximately 38% of total revenue, making them strategic priority markets for the business.

Finding 4 - People Performance: Margaret Peacock leads all employees with \$232,890 in sales while Steven Buchanan has the lowest performance at \$68,792. This gap suggests an opportunity for sales training and knowledge sharing across the team.

4. Recommendations

Recommendation 1 - Investigate 2015 Revenue Drop: The revenue decline from \$617,085 in 2014 to \$440,624 in 2015 requires urgent investigation. The sales team should analyse which customers stopped ordering and which product categories declined most to develop a recovery strategy.

Recommendation 2 - Expand in Top Markets: USA and Germany are the strongest markets. Northwind Traders should increase marketing spend and sales rep coverage in these two countries to further grow market share.

Recommendation 3 - Promote Low Performing Categories: Grains & Cereals and Produce are the lowest revenue categories. A targeted promotion or discount strategy for these categories could help increase their contribution to overall revenue.

Recommendation 4 - Sales Training Programme: The large gap between top performer Margaret Peacock (\$232,890) and bottom performer Steven Buchanan (\$68,792) suggests that a structured sales training and mentoring programme could significantly improve overall team performance.

5. Dashboard Link

The interactive Excel dashboard can be accessed via the following Google Drive link:

https://drive.google.com/drive/folders/18UQbCgFhaWpS5FMpxXCnzEvzyYjSbnrf?usp=drive_link